

By: Phelps Research Alliance - Group 6



CRIME SCENE

Tinder Loving

Initial Report

On March 19, 2024, at 2:20 a.m., Rochester Police responded to 1680 North Goodman St (Exxon) for a report of a vehicle stolen at gunpoint.

Victim (Blake Winters) claimed the incident happened one hour prior at a different location.

Officers drove Blake around the Clinton Section of the city until he identified the location - 367 Fernwood Avenue



1680 Fernwood (Exxon)



367 Fernwood Avenue

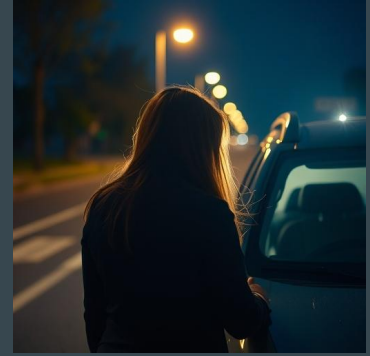
Blake's Story

Blake stated he was planning on meeting up with a female from Tinder, known to him only as Rachel. Blake parked his car on Fernwood Ave, and once Rachel arrived she got into the passenger seat to chat.

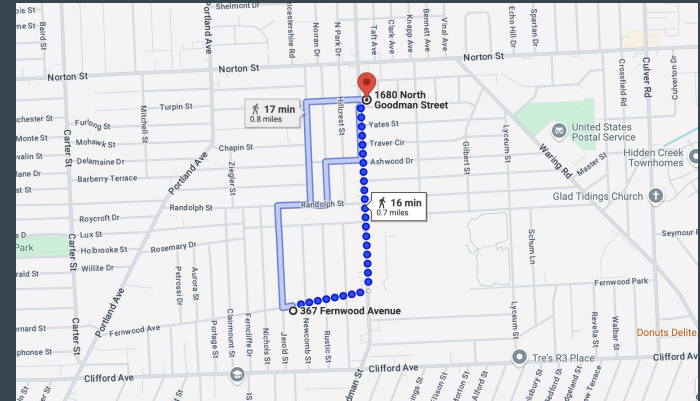
After a few minutes, a black male with a handgun approached Blakes window, demanding he exit the vehicle. When Blake complied, the male got into the driver's seat, and left with Rachel, as well as Blake's phone, which he left in the car.

Blake could not call 911 himself, so he walked to the nearest gas station he knew of and asked the clerk to call 911. Due to his phone being missing, Blake could also not access the Tinder information about Rachel.

A brief neighborhood check yielded negative results.



Blake and Rachel (AI Generated)



367 Fernwood to 1680 N Goodman

Basic Information

Victim: Blake Winters, age 24

Tinder Date: Rachel (last name and account information unknown)

Suspect 1: Black male, dark clothes, 6 feet tall, medium build, semi-automatic handgun

Victim's Vehicle: Black 2013 Monte Carlo



Blake Winters



Victim's Vehicle

Questioning Blake

Q: Can we see the Tinder information about Rachel?

A: My phone was in the car when it was stolen so I can't give you access.

Q: Can we have you permission to track your phone?

A: No, I do not need to find my phone, I can get another one. I just need make sure my stolen car is on record in case you find it.

Q: Would you want us to try and get information on Rachel and see if we can track her down?

A: Once again, I will not allow you to track any of my stuff. I just want my car reported as stolen. Am I free to leave now?

Ian Fochesato

What Do We Know About Blake?

- From questioning
 - His timeline isn't adding up from what we can tell so far.
 - Seems evasive when trying to get information that could help find the car.
 - Seems more interested in reporting the car stolen then finding it.
- From background check
 - Known criminal
 - Booking photo
 - Has a long history of larceny.
 - Has been arrested for possession.
 - Goes by the street name of “Dirty”.



We think he's lying. But we don't have enough proof yet.

Ian Fochesato



Canvassing Area Of The Crime

- Ring camera caught the “crime” taking place
 - Blake pulled up in his car and got out
 - Two people were seen getting into Blake's car and driving away
- Two new suspects identified
 - Unidentified white female
 - Unidentified black male
 - Seems like they knew Blake



LPR's And Social Media

- Tow trucks recently picked up Blake's car on LPR twice before "carjacking"
 - 18 Laser Street on March 15th
 - 72 Wilkins Street on March 18th
 - Both known drug houses
- Searched Blake's public social media
 - Lots of comments related to drugs and partying



Drug Houses

- Moved our focus to these drug houses
 - 18 Laser St Rochester, NY 14621
 - 72 Wilkins St Rochester, NY 14621
- Canvassed the area surrounding houses
 - Blake was seen at both drug houses multiple times
 - Seen with a UBM
 - Gained information through witnesses and personal cameras
 - Times and dates match with LPR readings



18 Laser Street



72 Wilkins Street

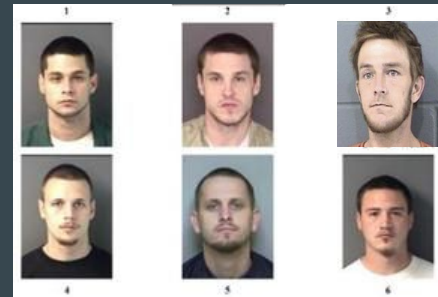
Calls For Service On Drug Houses

- 72 Wilkins St:
 - Police responded to the report of a robbery
 - Male victim claims two suspects knocked him to the ground and stole his money
 - Suspects are an UBM and UWM
- 18 Laser St:
 - Narcotics had multiple complaints of a drug house
 - Police responded to a male claiming he was robbed by two suspects
 - UWM and UBM



Interview With Robbery Victims

- Laser St robbery victim
 - Recognized the UWM as “Dirty”
 - Dirty drives a dark-colored Monte Carlo with spoke rims
- We looked into the victims' police reports from when they were robbed
 - They recognize the UBM but cannot name him
- Both victims ID Blake out of a 6-pack



Reade

Surveillance

- Surveilled Blake's house to find him and/or his accomplices
- Witnessed an unidentified black male visiting Blake's property
- After sending in his face to MCAC his identity came back as Wendell Pierce
- Wendell Pierce is a known criminal connected to multiple robberies in this area



Wendell Pierce

- DOB: September 13th, 1973
- Known for robbing drug users near pawn shops knowing they have money
- Also known for robbing drug houses
- Identified as one of the people who took Blake's car
- Identified by both victims of the robberies as the unidentified black male
 - This was through a photo array



Undercover

- Parolee Monitoring:
 - Placed monitored individuals in drug houses.
 - Ensured compliance and gathered leads.
- Mic'd Surveillance:
 - Equipped parolees with recording devices.
 - Collected conversations as evidence.
- Three Weeks of Surveillance:
 - Captured patterns of activity at drug houses.
 - Solidified the case for warrants.
- Collaborative Effort:
 - Coordinated with narcotics officers and SWAT.
 - Planned and executed raids.
- Expected Outcome:
 - Gathered evidence for arrests and drug busts.
 - Seized illegal contraband.



Arrest - Blake Winters

- Charges:
 - Filing a false police report
 - Involvement in both the Laser St. and Wilkins St. robbery.
- Details:
 - Blake fabricated a carjacking story to cover his role in the robberies.
 - Know criminal history with multiple larceny arrests.
 - Social media activity hinted at connections to illegal activities.



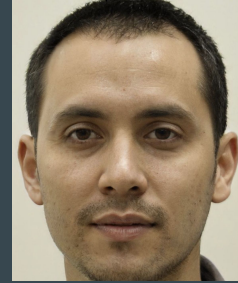
Arrest - Wendell Pierce

- Charges:
 - Two counts of armed robbery (Laser St. and Wilkins St.)
 - Targeting drug users near known drug houses.
- Details:
 - Identified through facial recognition during surveillance.
 - Linked to multiple robberies at drug houses based on witness accounts.
 - Known for following drug users from pawn shops to rob them.

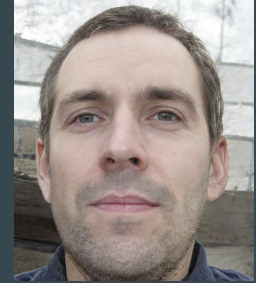


Arrest - Drug Dealers At 18 Laser St. And 72 Wilkins St.

- Charges:
 - Possession and distribution of illegal substances.
- Details:
 - Arrested during SWAT raids after weeks of surveillance.
 - Evidence sized:
 - Drugs (heroin, methamphetamine, or generic substances).
 - Cash, firearms, and other paraphernalia.



Chris Callas



William Hood



Real Story

The Tinder story is all a lie.

Blake thinks he is going to get caught for the Laser Street robbery because the victim recognized him. Blake tried to quickly report his car as stolen to make it seem like it couldn't have been him.

A detailed image of a New York State Department of Motor Vehicles 'REPORT OF MOTOR VEHICLE ACCIDENT' form. The form is titled 'MV-104 (2002) PAGE 1 of 2' and includes instructions for completion. It contains various sections for accident details, including vehicle information, driver information, accident location, and a diagram for accident reconstruction. The form is numbered 1 through 30 on the right side.

Technology Used

No Information Received:

- Street Cameras: No Footage of relevance near the scene.
- Preservation Order / Subpoena: Insufficient grounds to obtain Tinder or phone records.
- Cell Phone Towers / Phone Tracking: Not Pursued as the victim did not consent.

Technology Used

Information Received:

- Surveillance Tools:
 - Personal Cameras: Captured Blake exiting the car and walking away
 - LPR: Tracked Blake's car to 18 Laser St. and 72 Wilkins St.
 - Facial Recognition: Identified Wendell Pierce using surveillance footage.
 - GPS Parolee Monitoring: Confirmed parolees' presence at drug houses.
- Information Systems:
 - Record Management System: Provided Bake's criminal history.
 - Calls for Service: Highlighted prior robberies and complaints at drug houses.
 - DMV Database: verified vehicle ownership and registration.
- Investigative Techniques:
 - Undercover Work: Parolees made buys, leading to arrests
 - Search Warrants: Enabled SWAT raids at drug houses
 - 6-Pack Lineup: Helped victims identify Blake as a suspect.